The Dhāraṇī of the Vow Made by Siṃhanāda is a brief ritual incantation text, who

Toh 912 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī of the Vow Made by Siṃhanāda is a brief ritual incantation text, whose Sanskrit and Tibetan titles are not given in the opening lines and so are best described simply as corresponding to that English name. After an homage to Mañjughoṣa, it presents a dhāraṇī addressed to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva of great compassion. It then gives a short healing rite: one recites the mantra over eight small maṇḍalas made from cow dung that has not touched the ground, and smears the empowered substance on a sick person so that all illnesses are pacified. The text promises success within seven, thirteen, or twenty-one days for anyone who has not committed the five acts of immediate retribution, and it closes with Siṃhanāda's solemn vow that if the rite fails, he himself will bear the weight of those grave deeds. It is Toh 912 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, and it was rendered into Tibetan with the Indian preceptor Vāgīśvara among its translators.

Homage to Mañjughoṣa.

namo ratnatrayāya nama āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya tadyathā oṃ akaṭe vikaḍe nikaḍe kaṭaṃkaṭe karoṭe karota vīrye svāhā

In front of that Blessed One, using cow dung that has not fallen to the ground, make eight separate maṇḍalas. Recite the mantra up to thirteen times over each maṇḍala, then recite it over the remaining dung. If this is smeared on a sick person, all illnesses will be completely pacified.

It will succeed within seven days, or thirteen, or twenty-one, unless one has committed the five acts of immediate retribution. If it does not succeed in this way, I shall have committed the five acts of immediate retribution.

Here ends the Dhāraṇī of the Vow Made by Siṃhanāda.

It was translated by the Indian preceptor Vāgīśvara and the translator Lokya Sherab Tsek.

Translator's Notes

• The words for "cow dung that has not fallen to the ground" are written as a contracted form in the Tibetan. They are read here in the standard ritual sense, meaning dung caught before it

touches the earth.

The sentence on success is read as a promise with one exception. The rite succeeds within seven, thirteen, or twenty-one days, unless the practitioner has committed the five acts of immediate retribution (ānantarya).

The closing oath is Siṃhanāda's pledge, which gives the dhāraṇī its title. He stakes himself on the rite's efficacy: if it fails for someone free of those acts, he takes on the guilt of the five acts of immediate retribution.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.